

Answer Key: Smartphones and Human Behaviour Worksheet

Teacher's copy — do not distribute to students

Section	Tasks	Marks	Notes
Part A — Comprehension	A1, A2, A3	20 marks	1 mark per correct answer
Part B — Vocabulary	B1, B2	20 marks	1 mark per correct answer
TOTAL		40 marks	

PART A — COMPREHENSION ANSWERS

Task A1 — True / False / Not Given [7 marks]

Accept only TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN (or T / F / NG). No partial marks.

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|---------------------|--|
| 1. FALSE | <i>The article states smartphones became widespread in 'less than twenty years' — not fifty.</i> |
| 2. TRUE | <i>Part One: 'Dopamine is a chemical ... that plays a central role in motivation, reward, and pleasure.'</i> |
| 3. TRUE | <i>Part One: 'Their algorithms are specifically designed to maximise engagement.'</i> |
| 4. FALSE | <i>Part Two: 'Even the presence of a phone on the table ... reduces how much people feel connected.'</i> |
| 5. TRUE | <i>Part Two: 'Nomophobia ... describes the anxiety and distress that many people feel when ... separated from their smartphone.'</i> |
| 6. NOT GIVEN | <i>The article presents research and balanced perspectives but does not state that all researchers agree on government regulation.</i> |
| 7. TRUE | <i>Part Four: 'The people who feel most in control ... are ... those who use it most deliberately.'</i> |

Task A2 — Note Completion [9 marks — one word only]

Accept only the exact word from the article as listed below.

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|---------------------|---|
| 8. dopamine | <i>Part One: 'Every notification ... is a small dopamine hit.'</i> |
| 9. stronger | <i>Part One: 'the unpredictability of rewards ... actually makes the dopamine response stronger.'</i> |
| 10. gambling | <i>Part One: 'the same principle that makes gambling so difficult to stop.'</i> |

11.	focus	Part Two: 'heavy smartphone users find it increasingly difficult to sustain focus.' Accept: concentration.
12.	anxiety	Part Two: 'around two-thirds of people experience some level of anxiety.'
13.	compulsive	Part Two: 'smartphone use has become genuinely compulsive.'
14.	blue	Part Three: 'Screens emit a blue light that suppresses the production of melatonin.'
15.	anxiety	Part Three: 'increases the risk of anxiety and depression.'
16.	health	Part Three: 'a genuine and growing public health concern.'

Task A3 — Short Answer Questions [4 marks — 1 mark each]

Award 1 mark for any answer clearly conveying the key idea in the student's own words.

17.	Because the unpredictability of rewards (sometimes many likes, sometimes none) makes the dopamine response stronger — just as not knowing when a gamble will pay off keeps gamblers playing.	Key idea: unpredictable rewards → stronger dopamine response → same as gambling mechanism.
18.	Even just having the phone on the table (not being used) reduces how connected people feel to the person they are talking to.	Key idea: mere presence of phone reduces quality/feeling of connection. Accept: 'people feel less present'.
19.	People who feel in control decide when to check their phone rather than responding to every notification; they create phone-free times and use productivity tools to monitor their usage.	Key idea: deliberate / intentional use — they control the phone, not the other way around.
20.	The goal is NOT to get rid of the smartphone, but to develop a healthier and more intentional relationship with it.	Key idea: not elimination — intentional / deliberate / healthy use. Must include both the 'not' and the positive goal.

Task B1 — Vocabulary Matching [8 marks]

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|----|---------------------------|---|
| 1. | b — dopamine | <i>A brain chemical linked to pleasure, motivation, and reward.</i> |
| 2. | e — screen time | <i>The amount of time spent using screens such as phones, tablets, or computers.</i> |
| 3. | d — attention span | <i>The length of time a person can concentrate on a task without distraction.</i> |
| 4. | a — nomophobia | <i>The fear or anxiety of being without one's smartphone.</i> |
| 5. | g — digital detox | <i>A period of time deliberately spent away from phones and digital devices.</i> |
| 6. | c — compulsive | <i>Done regularly out of habit in a way that is difficult to control.</i> |
| 7. | f — connectivity | <i>The ability to stay connected with others across distances through technology.</i> |
| 8. | h — engagement | <i>The degree to which users interact with and spend time on a platform or app.</i> |

Task B2 — Gap-Fill [12 marks — 1 mark per gap]

Award 1 mark per blank filled correctly. Sentences 9, 11, 15, and 17 require 2–3 answers — mark each blank independently.

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| 9. | notification / dopamine / algorithm | 3 blanks — 1 mark each. |
| 10. | attention span / distraction | 2 blanks — 1 mark each. |
| 11. | nomophobia / anxiety | 2 blanks — 1 mark each. |
| 12. | compulsive / addiction | 2 blanks — 1 mark each. |
| 13. | connectivity | 1 blank. |
| 14. | mindfulness / wellbeing | 2 blanks — 1 mark each. Accept: screen time / productivity for first blank. |
| 15. | social media / engagement | 2 blanks — 1 mark each. |
| 16. | digital detox | 1 blank. |
| 17. | wellbeing / screen time | 2 blanks — 1 mark each. Accept: productivity / app for second blank. |

MARKING SUMMARY

A1 (T/F/NG): 7 marks · A2 (Note completion): 9 marks · A3 (Short answer): 4 marks · B1 (Matching): 8 marks · B2 (Gap-fill): 12 marks · TOTAL: 40 marks

